ALL INDIA COUNCIL FOR TECHNICAL EDUCATION

APPROVAL PROCESS HANDBOOK (2024-2027)

Statutory Norms and Standards for Technical Institutions in India

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION AND GENERAL PROCEDURES

Section 1.1: Scope, Applicability, and General Requirements

Clause 1.1.1: This Approval Process Handbook (2024-2027) is published under the authority of the All India Council for Technical Education Act, 1987 (52 of 1987). It governs the grant of approval for Setting Up New Technical Institutions, Extension of Approval (EoA) for existing institutions, Increase in Intake, and Introduction of New Courses in Engineering and Technology, Management, Pharmacy, MCA, and Architecture programmes nationwide.

Clause 1.1.2: Every Technical Institution shall strictly comply with the infrastructure norms, faculty requirements, statutory clearances, and financial prerequisites laid down herein. Failure to adhere to these standards shall invite penal action, reduction in sanctioned intake, or withdrawal of approval.

Clause 1.4.2: Technical Education Regulatory (TER) Processing Charges.

Table 1.1: TER Processing Fee Schedule for Setting Up New Technical Institutions
- Category (i): Central / State Government / Union Territory Institutions: Nil
- Category (ii): All other Institutions (including Minority, Registered Private Trusts, and Government-Aided Institutions) applying for setting up a new Technical Institution (Degree Engineering & Technology, Management, MCA, Pharmacy): Rs. 10.00 Lakh (Rupees Ten Lakh only).
Remittance of any amount less than Rs. 10.00 Lakh (e.g. Rs. 5.00 Lakh) constitutes an underpayment and renders the application NON-COMPLIANT under Chapter I, Clause 1.4.2, Table 1.1.

Clause 1.5.3: Minimum Operational Funds Requirement at Scrutiny.

Table 1.2: Minimum Operational Expense Fund Position at Scrutiny (FDR / Bank Deposits)
- Category (vii): Programmes in Computer Applications (MCA) / Management (MBA/PGDM): The applicant Trust or Society must demonstrate minimum operational funds of at least Rs. 50.00 Lakh (Rupees Fifty Lakh only) in the form of Fixed Deposit Receipts (FDRs) or unencumbered bank balances at the time of scrutiny. Showing funds lower than Rs. 50.00 Lakh (e.g. Rs. 35.00 Lakh) results in a non-compliant deficiency shortfall of Rs. 15.00 Lakh under Chapter I, Clause 1.5.3, Table 1.2.

CHAPTER 2: NORMS FOR LAND, LOCATION, AND SITE REQUIREMENTS

Section 2.1: Land Requirements for Technical Institutions

Clause 2.1.1: The minimum requirement of land for establishing and operating a Technical Institution in Degree Engineering and Technology, Management, and MCA programmes is determined by geographical location type.

Table 2.1: Minimum Land Requirement for Technical Institutions (Acres)

Programme | Rural Area | Urban Area | Mega/Metro Cities
Engineering & Technology (UG) | 7.5 Acres | 2.5 Acres | 1.5 Acres
Management (MBA/PGDM) | 1.0 Acres | 0.5 Acres | 0.5 Acres
Computer Applications (MCA) | 1.5 Acres | 0.75 Acres | 0.5 Acres
Architecture (B.Arch) | 2.5 Acres | 1.0 Acres | 0.75 Acres
Pharmacy (B.Pharm) | 2.0 Acres | 0.75 Acres | 0.75 Acres

Annexure 3.1: Norms for Land Continuity & Distance Verification in Hilly Areas

Annexure 3.1 (g) & (h): In Hilly Areas (including Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, and North Eastern States), the land can be spread across a maximum of 3 plots. The distance between any of the plots shall not exceed 2.0 km. Furthermore, the Academic, Instructional, Administrative, and Amenities areas must strictly be located in one single plot (main campus). Other designated plots may house sports grounds, student hostels, or staff quarters. An institution satisfying these conditions (such as Plot A housing Academic/Admin, Plot C housing sports ground, with distances 1.2 km and 1.8 km <= 2.0 km) is fully COMPLIANT with Annexure 3.1 (g) & (h).

Clause 2.1.3: Land Use Certificate (CLU). The applicant institution must possess an indisputable Land Use Certificate / Change of Land Use (CLU) order issued by the Competent Government Revenue Authority authorizing educational use. Applications with pending CLU or agricultural-only zoning shall be summarily rejected.

Clause 2.1.4: Exceptions for Mega Cities & Hilly Areas. For institutions situated in declared Mega Cities (Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bangalore, Hyderabad) or State Capitals, a land relaxation of up to 50% is admissible, provided the institution achieves compensatory vertical Floor Space Index (FSI/FAR) and furnishes an unconditional Fire and Structural Safety clearance.

CHAPTER 3: NORMS FOR FACULTY REQUIREMENTS AND CADRE RATIOS

Annexure 5.2: Norms for Faculty Requirements and Cadre Ratio for Technical Programmes

Clause 5.2: Faculty-to-Student Ratio (SFR) and Cadre Distribution. For Undergraduate Engineering & Technology programmes, the mandated Faculty-Student Ratio (SFR) is 1:20 (SFR = 20) based on approved total student enrollment S. Total Required Faculty = S / 20. The cadre distribution shall follow 1:2:6 (1 Professor : 2 Associate Professors : 6 Assistant Professors). For student intake of 300 per year across 4 years (Total S = 1200): Required Faculty = 1200 / 20 = 60 faculty members. Cadre distribution: Required Professors = (60 / 9) * 1 = 6.67 (rounded to 7), Required Associate Professors = (60 / 9) * 2 = 13.33 (rounded to 13), Required Assistant Professors = (60 / 9) * 6 = 40. An institution providing 50 faculty (3 Professors, 7 Associate Professors, 40 Assistant Professors) has an overall shortfall of 10 faculty members, a shortfall of 4 Professors, and a shortfall of 6 Associate Professors, rendering it NON-COMPLIANT under Annexure 5.2.

Chapter VI, Clause 6.14 (d) (iii): Ceiling on Adjunct Faculty and Professors of Practice

Clause 6.14 (d) (iii): To support industry integration, Autonomous and accredited Technical Institutions may avail the services of 'Adjunct Faculty' OR 'Professor of Practice' up to a maximum limit of 15% of the total required faculty strength. Engaging Adjunct Faculty or Professors of Practice totaling 22% of required faculty strength exceeds the 15% maximum permissible ceiling and is strictly NON-COMPLIANT under Chapter VI, Clause 6.14 (d) (iii).

CHAPTER 4: NORMS FOR BUILT-UP INFRASTRUCTURE AND AMENITIES

Annexure 3.2.1 (A): Instructional Area Requirements & Classroom Count Calculation

Clause 3.2.1 (A): Calculation of Minimum Classrooms for Technical Institutions (B.Tech / Engineering). The minimum number of dedicated instructional classrooms required shall be calculated using the statutory formula:
Required Classrooms = Total Divisions per year * Duration in years * 0.5
For a B.Tech institution conducting 4 courses, each having 2 divisions of 60 intake each (Total 8 divisions per year) with a course duration of 4 years, the calculation is:
Required Classrooms = 8 * 4 * 0.5 = 16 classrooms.
If the institute provides only 12 classrooms, there is a deficiency of 4 classrooms, resulting in a verdict of NON-COMPLIANT under Annexure 3.2.1 (A) - Instructional Area Requirements.

Clause 4.1.1: Minimum Total Built-up Area. A new Engineering & Technology college starting with an intake of up to 360 students shall have a minimum total built-up area of 4,000 square meters. As batches advance to full capacity (1440 students across 4 years), the institution must scale its total built-up instructional and administrative area to a minimum of 8,000 square meters.

CHAPTER 5: OPEN AND DISTANCE LEARNING (ODL) AND ONLINE LEARNING (OL)

Section 5.1: Permissibility and Prohibitions in ODL and Online Learning

Clause 5.1 (b): Prohibited Programmes in Distance and Online Education. The Council shall NOT allow Open and Distance Learning (ODL) or Online Learning (OL) at Diploma / Degree / Post Graduate Degree level in Engineering & Technology, Planning, Hotel Management, Applied Arts and Crafts, and Design. Any application seeking approval for a B.Tech degree or Engineering diploma in Computer Science or other engineering disciplines via ODL or Online mode is strictly PROHIBITED / INVALID APPLICATION under Chapter V, Clause 5.1 (b).

Section 5.3: Minimum Core Academic Staff at Headquarters for ODL / Online Programmes

Clause 5.3.3: Table 5.1 - Minimum Dedicated Academic Staff Required per Discipline / Specialization for Enrolment up to 5000 Students:
- 1 Professor (Discipline Head / Program Coordinator)
- 1 Associate Professor
- 2 Assistant Professors

For a Standalone Institution offering an online MBA program with an enrolment of 3000 students, the mandated requirement is 1 Professor, 1 Associate Professor, and 2 Assistant Professors. If the institution appoints only 1 Assistant Professor (total 3 staff), there is a shortfall of 1 Assistant Professor, rendering the institution NON-COMPLIANT under Chapter V, Clause 5.3.3, Table 5.1.

CHAPTER 6: DOCUMENT AUTHENTICITY AND STATUTORY FORENSICS

Section 6.1: Document Authenticity, QR Codes, and Anti-Fraud Verification

Clause 5.2.1: Verification of Visual Forensics. Submitted PDF documents and scanned approvals undergo Error Level Analysis (ELA) and Laplacian edge inspection. Any document exhibiting composite manipulation, localized text flattening, or forged administrative stamps shall result in instant disqualification and debarment for three academic years.

Clause 5.2.2: Cryptographic Receipt Integrity. Affidavits, University affiliation letters, and State NOCs must bear verifiable PKI digital signatures with intact certificate chains, or QR codes that resolve directly to authoritative domains (*.aicte-india.org or *.gov.in).